

How iMSA Broke the Project Funding Reflex at Portfolio Level

Nisrine Chaouki, sqli

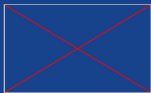
SAFe & AI
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AMSTERDAM, NETHERLANDS





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iMSA

Transformation Journey



iMSA : The IT Organization Behind MSA

MSA is the **social security system for the agricultural sector** in France



1

Stop shop



5.6 M

Beneficiaries



28.1 B€

Paid in services



14k

Employees



MSA Network

MSA Strategic plan (5 yrs)

CCMSA
Central Office of MSA

37 Regional offices
Local service delivery

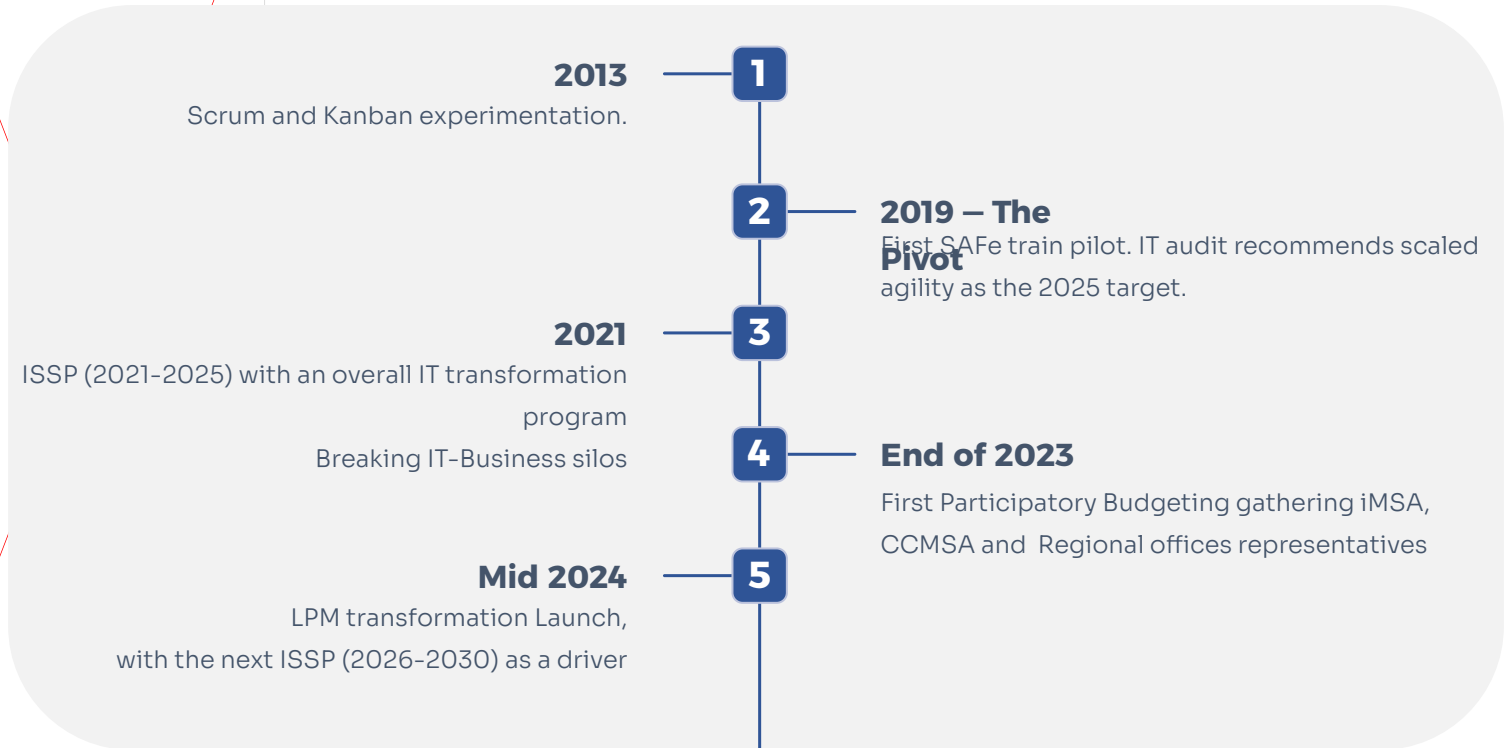


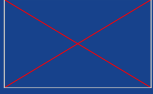
iMSA
IT for the MSA network
— **1,018 employees** + 450 IT partners

iMSA ISSP* (5 yrs)

*ISSP : Information system Strategic plan

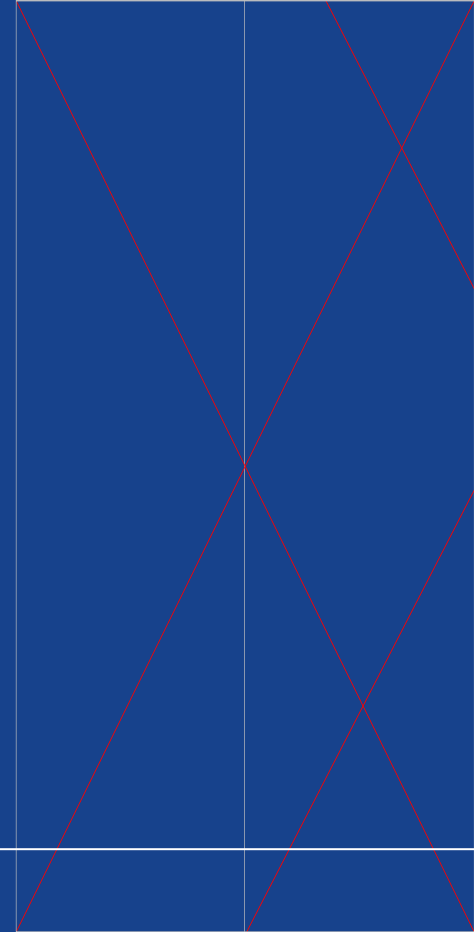
iMSA Transformation Journey since 2013





Participatory Budgeting

as the First Steppingstone



First PB surfaced the complexity of strategic alignment



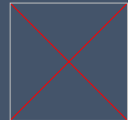
One-on-one negotiation

- Departments negotiating their budget one-on-one with leadership
- Driven by political considerations
- Missing the big picture and strategic clarity.



Collective understanding

- Bringing full picture to the table : Business domains, IT
- Make visible the complexity of trade-offs

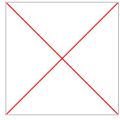


Investment dilution



- 250 projects growing while available funding did not.
- **Too broad** strategy to decide what to keep / give up
- ☐ Budgets spread thin to satisfy every department, Investments diluted, impacts minimal

Improving the PB : Building Strategic Clarity for 2025



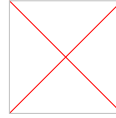
Start with what Chiefs do best : make decisions!

What's **critical for 2025** (in/out)



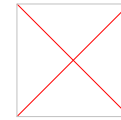
Extract the rationale behind the choices

Capturing the **why** behind each decision



Define the Strategy through OKR

Formulating the strategic objectives,
Not perfection



First wins towards strategic alignment

Wins

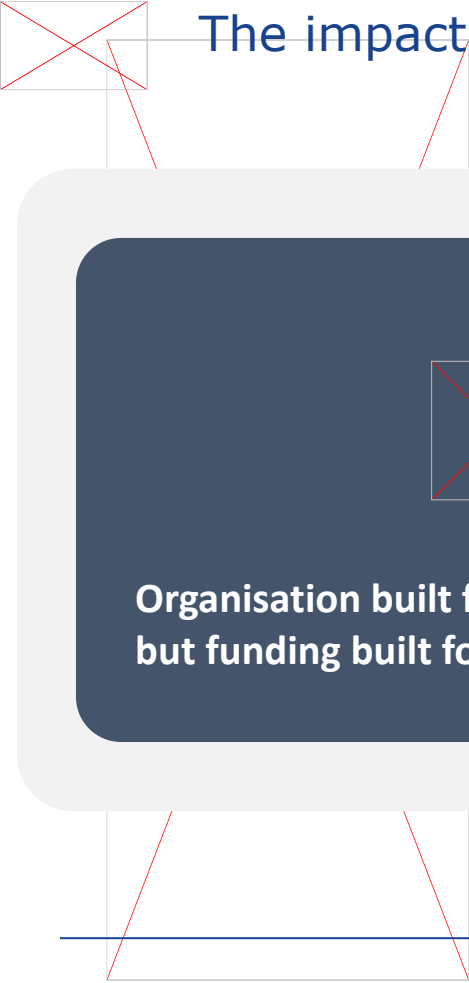
The ExCom building **clear strategy** as an input for PB

Investments guided by strategic goals

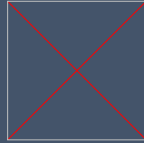
Make trade-offs and decide on projects to abandon

Stakeholders' alignment on a result they could carry on through the year

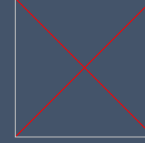




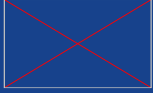
The impact the PB could bring was limited



**Organisation built for Agile Trains/Teams
but funding built for projects**



**The structure and content of the ISSP
was fixed**



The New ISSP

2026–2030

Information

Systems

Strategic

Plan

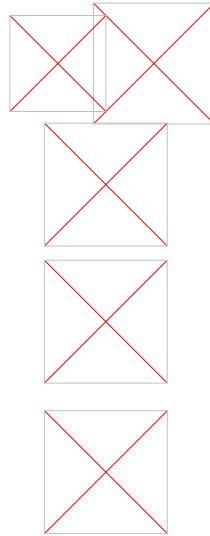




The New ISSP: The opportunity to redesign the overall structure

The New Approach

Strategy first



- Value Streams (DVS) as the organizing structure
- Business and IT co-owning their products, visions and Epics
- Cross-cutting Portfolio Epics with the relevant stakeholders
- OKRs introduced at strategic theme and Epic levels for outcome orientation

What Actually Changed



250

Initiatives Before

Fragmented projects



90

Initiatives After

Structured around strategy and value streams

DVS-Based Budget Allocation

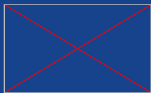
Budget reductions based on value stream investment intent
— not line-by-line project review.

Outcome-Driven Trade-offs

Prioritization guided by expected ROI
— not just cost alone.

Strategy led Decisions

Leaders traded off fewer, better-defined initiatives with clear strategic rationale.



New Governance Model

To operate the ISSP



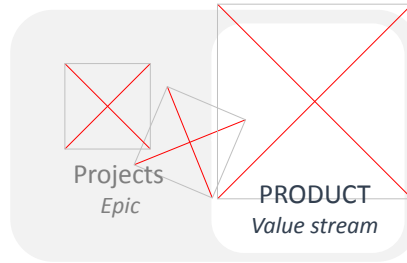
Our main goals of the LPM transformation

Steering



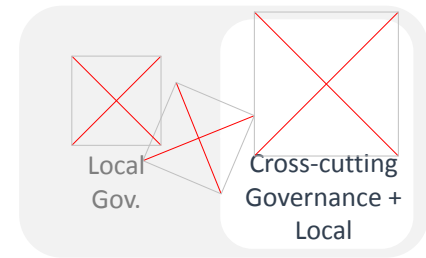
Outcome-driven management

Funding



Value Stream funding

Governance



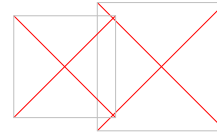
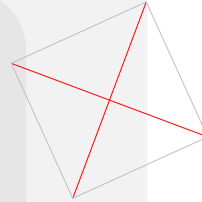
Supporting cross-value-stream operational governance

Switching to DVS funding



Projects *Epic*

- Departments owning a budget for each of their project
- Sole decision-making authority over funding
- Unstable Trains
- Changing priorities = moving people



Developpement Value Streams

- Funding DVS based on the ambitions and intentions
- Advancing the overall portfolio priorities
- Investing into the DVS capabilities and performance

A multi-level governance for the ISSP



ISSP oversight by supervisory authorities

EXECUTIVE GOVERNANCE (ExCom)

LEAN PORTFOLIO MANAGEMENT

IT PORTFOLIO GOVERNANCE

VALUE STREAM GOVERNANCE

PRODUCT DEVELOPMENT FLOW

Year

PHASE 1



Strategy,
Budgets & Roadmaps

Quarter

PHASE 2



Follow up on
Execution & Operations

PHASE 3



Performances reviews &
outcome evaluation

New Governance - Seminar

march 10th 2026

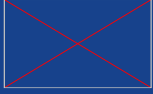


EXECUTIVE GOVERNANCE (ExCom)

LEAN PORTFOLIO MANAGEMENT

IT PORTFOLIO GOVERNANCE

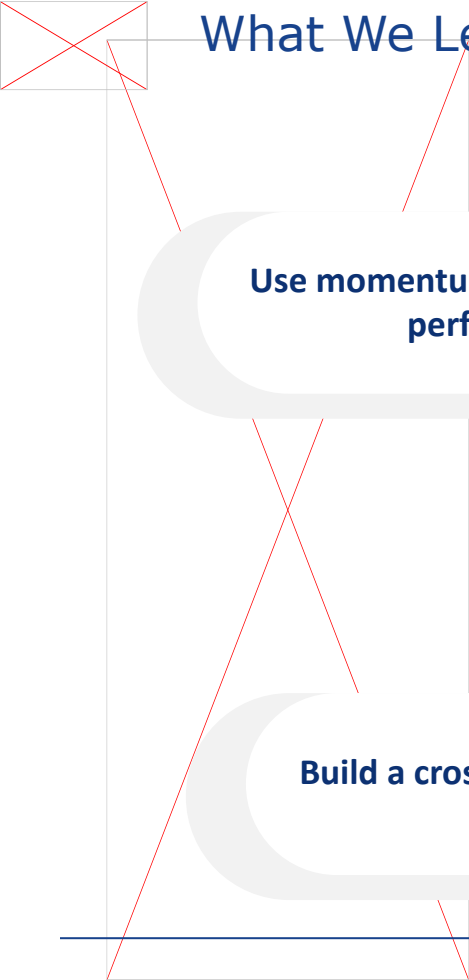




Learnings

Way Forward





What We Learned Along the Way

Use momentum, don't wait for the perfect Timing

Solve the problems people already feel

Build the right level of sponsorship

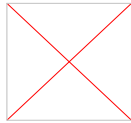
Build a cross-functional Transformation Team

Give new ideas time to sink in

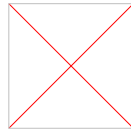
What the future looks like



Progressive Evaluation of Outcomes



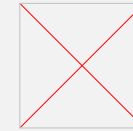
Incremental
implementation
of Epics



Outcome
oriented
increments



Developping the
ability to mesure
targetted
indicators



Reviewing results
on a regular basis
Prior to BP



Growing the digital future together

Follow us!



THANK YOU

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